

Scalability

You can use digital pictures in a lot more applications than just a photo album. You can make them into backgrounds for your computer desktop or even your cell phone. You can also use digital photos in a catalogue for your store or in a business presentation. The options are limited only by your imagination.

Sharing

The most highly-used feature of digital images is that they can be easily shared with your friends or relatives. Instead of going through the process of getting your negatives re-developed, you can simply e-mail your digital image to anyone who wants a copy.

Achieve Perfection

If there's something missing in your picture, you can add it digitally on your home computer. Fix red eyes, correct the colours and just about do anything you want with it. Since you have the freedom to view your images before printing them, there is absolutely no holding back on the aspects you can manipulate in those images before printing them.

On the flip side, we'd be lying if we said that film photography didn't have a few compelling advantages over its digital counterpart. Here's looking at a few.

Battery Life

With film cameras, batteries are the least of your worries. Two standard alkaline AA batteries will last you for multiple rolls. Since everything inside a film camera is mainly mechanical, the battery's main purpose is powering the flash.

Digital cameras, on the other hand, can suck the battery dry in less than an hour if you're not careful, since it's completely com-

**INFO**

Many cameras use AA batteries. If yours does, and you'll have access to an electrical outlet, consider getting a battery charger and rechargeable Ni-MH (nickel-metal hydride) batteries. Recharging saves you money and reduces environmental waste. But if you know you'll constantly be on the go, get long-life batteries, such as the powerful Kodak or Uniross rechargeable Li-Ion (lithium-ion) batteries and a back-up set, so you don't have to worry about running out of power. Even if your camera uses a special camera battery, carry a backup. It's critical for taking pictures on a trip.